



**MORE
GOOD
DAYS**
together

**Mental Health Month
Planning Guide 2026**

MHA
Mental Health America

MAKING MAY COUNT, TOGETHER

Since founding Mental Health Month in 1949, Mental Health America (MHA) has led the effort every May to promote mental wellness nationwide. This year, MHA's theme for Mental Health Month is *More Good Days, Together*. This reflects the heart of our mission: helping people have more good days by meeting them where they are, supporting them as whole people, and understanding that "good" is defined by their unique experience and goals.

To help you bring this year's theme to life in your own community, we've put together the 2026 Mental Health Month Planning Guide.

This guide is designed to make organizing meaningful Mental Health Month activities doable. Whether you are trying to make your workplace more supportive, bringing people together in your community, working in health care, or helping students thrive, you'll get practical ideas and tools you can actually use.

Inside, you'll find:

- **Activities to bring people together:** Outreach ideas that encourage conversation and spark connection.
- **Real-life examples:** See what's worked for others and adapt their activities for your audience.
- **Ready-to-use communication tools:** Customizable email and newsletter content, and talking points to help you share the message and save time.
- **Ways to work together:** How to partner with Mental Health America to extend your reach and impact.

Stay tuned for the release of the Mental Health Month Action Guide in April. The Action Guide is a roadmap for supporting more good days, individually and together. It will feature online activities, printable tools, and other resources to: encourage people to **reflect** on what a good day looks like to them; **connect** people to tools and resources that support them on their unique path with mental health; and **empower** individuals, organizations, and communities to have more good days, together.

We're here to help

If you have questions, please email Danielle Fritze at dfritze@mhanational.org.



ENGAGING OUTREACH IDEAS

Are you ready to help your community have more good days, together?

Now is the time to start thinking about how you can support those around you and spark new connections. Whether you're planning something big or small, the ideas below are designed to get people talking and feeling supported during Mental Health Month.

SUPPORT MORE GOOD DAYS IN YOUR COMMUNITY



- Host a mental health screening event at a library, community center, or local business. Action Boxes are available for purchase in the MHA Store and include everything you need to get started.
- Plan an advocacy event, such as a town hall or State Capitol Day, to discuss mental health policy needs in your community.
- Contact buildings and structures (like bridges and monuments) in your community to ask them if they can light up public spaces green, the official awareness color for mental health, to honor Mental Health Month.
- Collect and share short community stories or written reflections about what helps people have more good days, and use them to support local advocacy efforts.
- Organize community swap events that emphasize togetherness and skill-sharing. These could include recipe swaps for gut-friendly or comfort foods, hobby swaps, or clothing and accessory swaps to encourage joy through self-expression.
- Partner with local businesses to create pop-up wellness spaces or host mental health-focused events. For instance, you may organize open-mic or art-share nights that are focused on process, not just performance.
- Coordinate adventure days at parks, museums, and other local attractions to encourage connection and exploration.



- Organize a community art project, such as a mural or exhibit on mental health awareness.
- Start a mental health-focused book club using books like “Where to Start” or “A Mind That Found Itself” by Mental Health America’s founder, Clifford W. Beers.
- Set up a public bulletin board where people can post notes about what helps them have more good days.
- Contact your local MHA affiliate to discuss ideas or collaborate. Use our affiliate finder to find the location closest to you.

affiliates in action



Mental Health Connecticut (MHC) launched its fourth annual “Let’s Face It” campaign in May 2025. “Let’s Face It” sparked statewide engagement through distributing free lawn signs to build awareness of Mental Health Month, sharing daily digital educational content, hosting free public mental health events, and participating in the “Light It Up Green” partnership with local landmarks. As a result, the campaign raised record-breaking funds to support MHC’s community programs, including the Art of Wellbeing studio.

For Mental Health Month, MHA of East Tennessee dominated the airwaves in partnership with WBIR (NBC) through weekly “Mental Health Mondays” segments, a prime-time special, and targeted commercials driving people to mental health screening tools. In the community, they participated in 11 speaking engagements and partnered with Jack’s Café for the “You Can’t Pour From an Empty Cup” campaign to raise awareness and encourage conversations.



SUPPORT MORE GOOD DAYS THROUGH CORPORATE PARTNERSHIPS

GO GREEN FOR MENTAL HEALTH

- **Turn a product green**, the color of mental health awareness, and donate a percentage of sales to support MHA's work.
- **Light up your locations green** to spread mental health awareness during Mental Health Month.
- **Wear green at events** to spark conversation and normalize mental health support (e.g., the New York Yankees' mental health awareness game).



GIVE AND BE SEEN

- **Help us fundraise** by making MHA one of your corporate matching organizations. Your employees can **double their impact** by donating to advance mental health.
- **Make a donation** to MHA in honor of your commitment to mental health. Contributions of \$5,000 or more include green mental health awareness bracelets for employees.

ACTIVATE YOUR BRAND THROUGH PURPOSE-DRIVEN CAMPAIGNS

- **Launch a cause marketing or retail campaign** that showcases your company's support for mental health. MHA will collaborate on message creation and amplification.
- **Run a proceeds campaign** and donate a portion of sales to MHA, to connect everyday purchases to meaningful impact.



LEAD AS A NATIONAL SPONSOR

- **Sponsor a day of impact** by aligning your corporate priorities with MHA's mission and sharing co-created content with our community.
- **Sponsor MHA's Mental Health Month Action Guide**, featuring your company's name and logo throughout the campaign.

For more details, contact Niya McCray-Brown at nmbrown@mhanational.org.

SUPPORT MORE GOOD DAYS IN THE WORKPLACE

- Organize a "Be Seen in Green" fundraiser among employees and match funds raised.
- Purchase self-care items from the MHA Store. Distribute them widely or use them as prizes in contests or giveaways.
- Feature healthy snacks in break rooms, and consider printing or sharing the link to MHA's webpage on the gut-brain connection.
- Hold a workplace wellness event, such as a walk or "lunch and learn" with a mental health professional. Here are 12 tips to help you start planning.
- Share information about mental health benefits and resources available in your workplace.
- Share our Mental Health Month calendar (coming in April) with staff to inspire small actions that help support more good days.
- Encourage employees to take a free, anonymous mental health test at mhascreening.org.
- Feature mental health topics in company-wide communications. **Use the samples in this guide!**



According to 2025 workplace mental health data, **95% of top employers run awareness or literacy campaigns to promote mental health and available resources.**

MHA's Bell Seal for Workplace Mental Health is the nation's **top recognition** for U.S. employers committed to creating mentally healthy workplaces. Join **Harley-Davidson, Choctaw Nation of Oklahoma, L.L.Bean, WebMD Health Services**, and hundreds of other employers with Bell Seal certification.

Learn more and apply at mhanational.org/bestemployers.

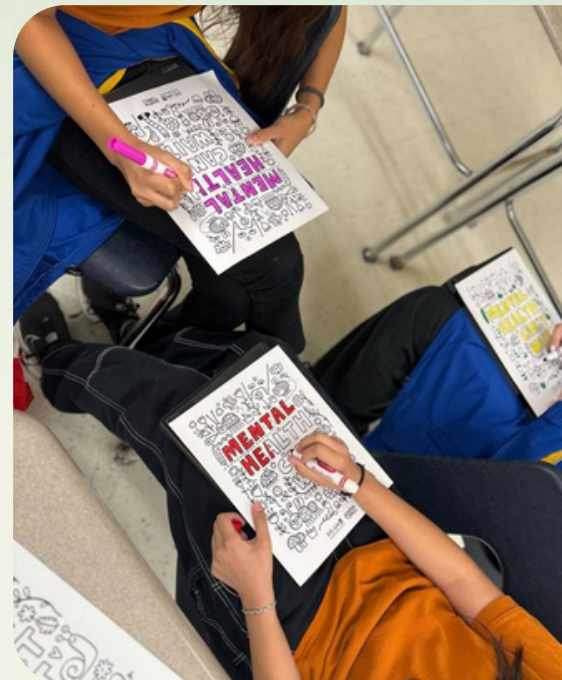
partners in action



To celebrate Mental Health Month, Citizens – Mental Health America’s (MHA) founding financial services partner – hosts their annual “Move for Mental Health” volunteer and well-being initiative. Employees log activities, including but not limited to walking, running, yoga, and so much more, to prioritize their well-being. These efforts reflect an ongoing commitment to supporting not just communities, but the unique well-being journey of each colleague. Thousands of employees join in by incorporating movement into their day, whether through walking meetings, team stretch breaks, or whatever type of movement feels right for them, ensuring everyone can contribute and make a positive impact together.

SUPPORT MORE GOOD DAYS IN EDUCATION SETTINGS

- Create a safe, anonymous space where students can submit mental health questions for staff to answer during classroom discussions, in school newsletters, or in morning announcements.
- Invite peer specialists to speak about personal experiences at an assembly.
- Collect student responses about what helps them have a good day, as well as suggestions for wellness tools and coping strategies, to be featured in school-wide communications.
- Create “Ask Me Anything” online events for parents featuring behavioral health experts.
- Share short conversation prompts to help families talk about sleep, stress, routines, and connection at home.
- Share mental health resources on topics that matter to students, such as [MHA’s guide for supporting friends](#), and ensure students know where to get help if they need it.
- Coordinate a school-wide art project that raises mental health awareness. You could ask students to create artwork that symbolizes the things that bring them joy or peace of mind and use them all in an exhibit, or [paint a mural](#) together.





- Incorporate emotional well-being into lesson plans with [these classroom activity guides](#).
- Share mental health-themed books, movies, and media with students, display them in the library, and create a featured [reading list](#). Offer discussion and project opportunities afterward.
- Create visual displays with student- and staff-created messages about what helps their school community have more good days, together.
- Organize a “wear your mood” day to encourage comfort and self-expression.
- Share [MHA’s Mental Health Action Bracelets](#) (available in English and Spanish) with students and staff to encourage conversations around what kind of day they are having.
- Dedicate a professional development day to mental health.
- Offer a morning yoga or meditation class for staff.
- Provide a wellness space for teachers with stress-relief items like weighted blankets and aromatherapy, or items from the [MHA Store](#).
- Arrange for employee benefit providers to educate staff on available mental health resources.



EVERYTHING YOU NEED TO TURN AWARENESS INTO ACTION IN YOUR COMMUNITY

[Shop now](#)

store.mhanational.org

100% of proceeds support
Mental Health America



KEY MESSAGES



To support communications for 2026 Mental Health Month in May, Mental Health America developed the following key messages and themes. Please feel free to use or adapt these messages when you are engaging in conversations online, speaking at community events, or sharing resources with your network.

MENTAL HEALTH MONTH BACKGROUND

- Mental Health America founded Mental Health Month in 1949 and has led the effort every May to promote mental wellness nationwide. This annual campaign unites millions of people to promote awareness of mental health topics, share resources, and advocate for the well-being of all.

2026 MENTAL HEALTH MONTH THEME: *MORE GOOD DAYS, TOGETHER*

- Mental Health America is on a mission to help people have more good days by meeting them where they are, supporting them as whole people, and understanding that “good” is defined by their unique experience and goals.
- The path may look different for everyone, but we *all* deserve more good days, together.
- This May, MHA’s *More Good Days, Together* campaign will equip individuals, organizations, and communities with practical steps and tools to drive tangible and meaningful change.

2026 MENTAL HEALTH MONTH FOCUS AREAS

Mental Health America’s 2026 Mental Health Action Guide (coming in April) will center around the four focus areas and related key messages below. The Action Guide will feature online activities, printable tools, and other resources to: encourage people to **reflect** on what a good day looks like to them; **connect** people to tools and resources that support them on their unique path with mental health; and **empower** individuals, organizations, and communities to have more good days, together.

DEFINING GOOD DAYS

- This Mental Health Month, we encourage everyone to reflect on what a “good day” looks like to them.
- “Good” doesn’t have to mean happy or productive. It can mean calm, neutral, comfortable, manageable, or something else. It can change over time. It’s different for everyone, and only you can define what a good day looks like to you.
- No matter how you are feeling in this moment, remember that more good days are possible, help is available, and you are not alone.
- If having good days feels hard, you can check on your mental health with a free, quick, anonymous test at mhascreening.org.

KEY MESSAGES (CONT'D)

CARING FOR YOUR WHOLE SELF: MIND & BODY

- You cannot separate mental health from physical health. They are equally important and deeply connected.
- Our sleep, stress, relationships, nutrition, environment, and other health conditions all impact — and are impacted by — our mental health.
- Many factors that affect our health are beyond our control. Even when we can't change everything, noticing what we can influence is important for our well-being. Whether it's finding ways to move that you enjoy, connecting with your community, or remembering to drink water — small wins matter.

WORKING TOGETHER FOR MORE GOOD DAYS

- Having more good days isn't a solo mission. Check in with friends, colleagues, and loved ones to see how they're feeling, and offer support and encouragement.
- Connection is protection, and you don't have to carry the weight of "not-so-good" days alone. Even small moments of connection — whether in person or virtual — can reduce stress and anxiety, and remind us we're not the only ones feeling what we're feeling.
- Communities thrive when they prioritize mental health. When we take action together, we can expand access to the care, community, and connection that make more good days possible for all. Join MHA's advocacy network: mhanational.org/become-an-advocate

FINDING THE RIGHT PATH FOR YOU

- There is no health without mental health. 1 in 5 people experience a mental health condition each year — and 5 in 5 are managing their mental health every day.
- Mental health is deeply personal, and what works for one person may not work for another. It is important to explore which practices, treatments, or other supports best fit your unique needs and circumstances.
- The path may look different for everyone, but we all deserve more good days, together.

KICKOFF EMAIL TEMPLATE



Use this email to kick off Mental Health Month and inform those you serve about resources and planned activities in May. Please note that this email is intended to be sent no earlier than April 15 to ensure that all Action Guide resources are live on Mental Health America's website.

Subject: Join [ORGANIZATION NAME] in making more good days, together.

Dear [RECIPIENT NAME/GROUP],

As we head into May, [ORGANIZATION NAME] is proud to recognize Mental Health Month. This year, we're joining Mental Health America to focus on a simple, shared goal: helping people have more good days, together.

Having "more good days, together," doesn't mean pretending everything is great or ignoring the challenges we're navigating. "Good" doesn't have to mean happy. Having a good day can be anchored in moments when a burden feels a little lighter after you talk about it, or when a small win gives you a boost of confidence. Good is defined by you.

This May, we invite you to join us as we explore ways to create moments of connection, joy, or other things that help you have a "good" day—whatever that looks like for you.

Participate in activities to support mental health and well-being: [LIST SPECIFIC EVENTS/ACTIVITIES]

Share what helps you: [HIGHLIGHT ANY WAYS YOU PLAN TO FACILITATE NETWORKING OR SHARING]

Strengthen our community: Create more good days for [CITY/TOWN] by getting involved with [LOCAL MENTAL HEALTH ORGANIZATION/INITIATIVE/VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITY]

Find tools to support your mental health: [ORGANIZATION NAME] is sharing the tools below to help, no matter what kind of day you're having:

- [LINK TO ORGANIZATION'S MENTAL HEALTH RESOURCES]
- [INFORMATION ABOUT EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE PROGRAM/STUDENT COUNSELING SERVICES]
- [OTHER RELEVANT RESOURCES]
- Check on your mental health: Take a quick, free, and anonymous screening at mhascreening.org. If you are in crisis, call or text 988 for 24/7 help.

Looking for more information? Make sure to visit Mental Health America's website at mhanational.org/may for additional activities, tools, and resources to help support your well-being this Mental Health Month.

If you have any questions or need support, please don't hesitate to reach out to [CONTACT PERSON/DEPARTMENT] at [CONTACT INFORMATION].
Wishing you a meaningful Mental Health Month ahead.

Best regards,

[YOUR NAME] [YOUR TITLE] [ORGANIZATION NAME]

SAMPLE ARTICLE



Use this sample article in your organization's newsletter or blog to bring attention to the 2026 Mental Health Month campaign. Feel free to adapt the language to best fit your audience.

More good days, together: A mission for May

May is Mental Health Month, and [ORGANIZATION NAME] is joining Mental Health America (MHA) to focus on a simple, shared goal: helping people have more good days, together.

MHA's *More Good Days, Together* campaign is about meeting people where they are and recognizing that "good" looks different for everyone. It doesn't always mean being happy or productive; sometimes a good day is simply one that feels manageable, calm, or comfortable.

Here is how we can start building more good days, together.

1. Define what "good" means to you

Take a moment to ask yourself, "What does a good day look like for me?" It's okay if your answer changes over time.

If having good days (or even thinking about good days) feels hard, know that help is available and that you are not alone. Check on your mental health with a free, quick, anonymous test at mhascreening.org.

2. Care for your whole self

You cannot separate mental health from physical health. They are equally important and deeply connected. Our sleep, stress, relationships, nutrition, environment, and other health conditions all impact — and are impacted by — our mental health.

We also know that many factors that affect our health are beyond our control. Even when we can't change everything, noticing what we can influence is important for our well-being. Whether it's finding ways to move that you enjoy, connecting with your community, or remembering to drink water, small wins matter.

It's also important to listen to what your body is telling you. Sometimes physical symptoms are our mind's way of asking for help.

3. Work together for more good days

Having more good days isn't a solo mission. Connection is protection, and you don't have to carry the weight of "not-so-good" days alone. Even small moments of connection — whether in person or virtual — can reduce stress and anxiety, and remind us we're not the only ones feeling what we're feeling.

Check in with friends, colleagues, and loved ones to see how they're feeling — simple, honest conversations are a great way to support the people you care about.

SAMPLE ARTICLE (CONT'D)

You can also make a difference for your community and communities across the country. When we take action together, we can expand access to the care, community, and connection that make more good days possible for all. Join MHA's advocacy network: mhanational.org/become-an-advocate.

4. Find your path

Mental health isn't one-size-fits-all. What works for one person might not work for you, and that's okay.

Take time this May to explore what sparks joy, brings you peace, or helps you feel good. Often, we put our own well-being on the back burner in favor of taking care of others. Or, don't give ourselves time to reflect on what we really need to feel well. Remember that relaxation, hobbies, and creative pursuits are crucial for our mental health and well-being! The path may look different for everyone, but we all deserve more good days, together.

Resources at your fingertips

Visit mhanational.org/may for activities, tools, and resources to help you reflect and connect, and support your mental health journey.

No matter how you are feeling in this moment, remember: more good days are possible, help is available, and you are not alone.

Let's make it happen, together.

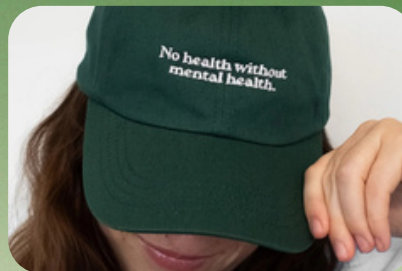
Be Seen in Green

Wear the official color of mental health

Join our "Be Seen in Green" challenge this May! Throughout Mental Health Month, wear green and fundraise to show your support for mental health.



Take
10% off
bulk orders of
50 items or more



There's
no health
without
mental
health.

Shop now

store.mhanational.org

100% of proceeds support
Mental Health America

